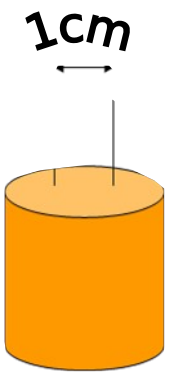
Aim

To find out which part of your body is the most sensitive to touch.



Method

1. Work in pairs. Decide which areas of skin to test e.g. fingertip, forehead, knee, elbow etc.
2. The tester randomly writes down a '1' or a '2' for each attempt in the 2nd column of the table. The subject must not see.
3. The tester **gently** presses one or two points (according to the table) against the subject's skin.
4. Tick the third column if the subject guessed correctly. Repeat steps 3-4 until all 10 attempts have been made.
5. Total the correct answers. This is the subject's score for that part of the skin.
6. Repeat all the steps for a different area of skin.

Area of skin:		
Attempt	1 or 2 points?	Correct?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
Total		

Area of skin:		
Attempt	1 or 2 points?	Correct?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
Total		

Area of skin:		
Attempt	1 or 2 points?	Correct?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
Total		

Area of skin:		
Attempt	1 or 2 points?	Correct?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
Total		

Area of skin:		
Attempt	1 or 2 points?	Correct?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
Total		

Conclusion

The most sensitive part of my skin to touch is _____.

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Teaching notes

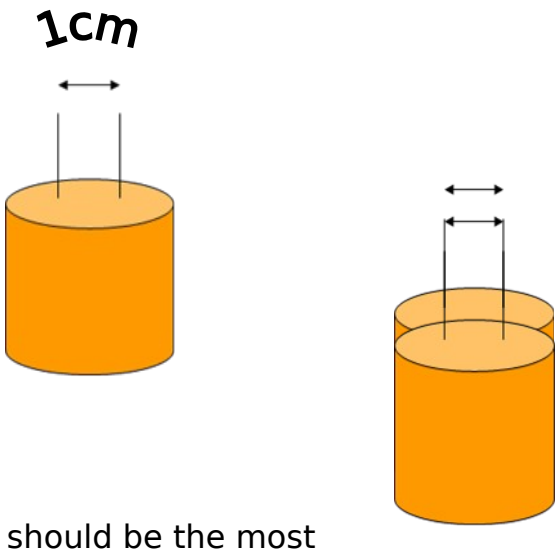
Duration

The investigation should take about 20 minutes, depending on how many body parts are tested.

Equipment per pair of students:

- 2 x worksheets
- 1 x touch tester
- blindfold (or the subject can close their eyes)

The touch tester can be made by pushing two pins into a rubber bung, 1cm apart.



Further discussion

Try to encourage students to test their fingertips – this should be the most sensitive part of the body.

Discuss with pupils what detects the touch (receptors) and how you are aware of it (nerve impulses to the brain). Discuss what makes some areas more sensitive than others, i.e. a higher density of touch receptors.